1 · Symbols & cash-flow timing

S_0, S_t, S_T: underlying now, at t, at expiry; K: strike; T: years; r: continuous domestic risk-free rate. c, p: European call/put; C, P: American.

PV of strike K at T: Ke^{-rT}; future value of K: Ke^{rT}. D: PV of known dividends; q: continuous dividend yield; r_f: foreign rate.

Payoff = expiry cash flow. **Profit** = payoff minus cost (same time basis). Premium at 0: subtract premium for unfinanced convention, or premium e^{rT} at expiry if financed.

2 · Contracts & four positions

Forward: obligation; long $S_T - K$, short $K - S_T$. Futures: standardized, daily mark-to-market. Option: buyer's right, writer's obligation; premium upfront.

European: exercise at T only. American: may exercise earlier. Hedger reduces exposure; speculator takes risk; arbitrage buys cheap/sells expensive equivalent cash flows.

Long position	Payoff	BE*
Call	$\max(S_T - K, 0)$	$K + c_0$
Put	$\max(K - S_T, 0)$	$K - p_0$

Short = negative long payoff/profit. *BE ignores financing. Long option max loss = premium; call upside unbounded; put payoff at most K.

ITM call $S > K$; ITM put $S < K$; ATM $S = K$. ITM ≠ profitable. Intrinsic = exercise payoff; time value = price − intrinsic.

Q · Buy a call: payoff/profit? $K = 50$, premium 4; ignore interest. At $S_T = 62$: payoff $62 - 50 = 12$, profit $12 - 4 = 8$ per share. At 48: do not exercise; payoff 0, loss = premium 4.

3 · Trading & value drivers

Multiply per-unit amounts by contract multiplier (lecture stock convention: 100). Class: call/put on underlying; series: same strike/expiry. Close long by selling same series; close short by buying it.

Q · Bid 4, ask 4.50: trading cost? Buy at ask, sell at bid: spread $4.50 - 4 = .50$; midpoint $(4 + 4.50)/2 = 4.25$. Immediate 100-share round trip loses $100(.50) = 50$ before fees.

Mark-to-market: observed quote; mark-to-model: model inputs. Margin is collateral. Initial deposit; maintenance threshold; margin call restores required balance. Futures/writers can face obligations; fully paid option buyer loses at most premium.

Input ↑	Call	Put
S / K	+ / −	− / +
σ	+	+
r / dividends	+ / −	− / +

Longer expiry: American value cannot fall; European not unconditional. $C \geq c$, $P \geq p$.

4 · Bounds: no dividends

Frictionless trade, shorting and borrowing/lending at r; same underlying/strike/expiry for comparisons.

$\max(S_0 - Ke^{-rT}, 0) \leq c \leq S_0$

$\max(Ke^{-rT} - S_0, 0) \leq p \leq Ke^{-rT}$

American: $\max(S_0 - K, 0) \leq C \leq S_0$; $\max(K - S_0, 0) \leq P \leq K$ for $r \geq 0$.

Proof pattern: call + bond paying K dominates stock; put + stock dominates bond. Buy underpriced dominating portfolio, sell dominated one.

5 · Parity, dividends & exercise

$c + Ke^{-rT} = p + S_0$ (European, no dividends). Both sides pay $\max(S_T, K)$.

$c = p + S_0 - Ke^{-rT}$

$p = c + Ke^{-rT} - S_0$

$S_0 = c - p + Ke^{-rT}$.

Arbitrage: sell expensive side, buy cheap side; initial receipt, terminal cancellation. Negative bond term = borrow.

Known dividends: D = their PV.

$c + D + Ke^{-rT} = p + S_0$

$c \geq \max(S_0 - D - Ke^{-rT}, 0)$

$p \geq \max(D + Ke^{-rT} - S_0, 0)$.

American bounds ($r \geq 0$):

$S_0 - K \leq C - P \leq S_0 - Ke^{-rT}$

with dividends, lower bound $S_0 - D - K$.

No-dividend call, $r \geq 0$: $C = c$; do not exercise early (lose optionality, pay strike sooner). Put may exercise deep ITM to receive K earlier. Dividends may favor call exercise just before ex-dividend. Always compare continuation.

At a cash dividend: $S_{after} = S_{before} -$ cash dividend. Cash amount ≠ PV ≠ continuous yield. A yield CRR tree is not an exact cash-dividend tree.

6 · Strategy quick reference

Same expiry unless noted. $K_1 < K_2 < K_3$; net debit = cost paid. Profit below ignores financing. Add signed legs, split at strikes, subtract net cost.

Position	Payoff / use
Covered call $S - c(K)$	$\min(S_T, K)$ Income, capped upside
Protective put $S + p(K)$	$\max(S_T, K)$ Floor on stock value
Bull call $c(K_1) - c(K_2)$	$\min(\max(S_T - K_1, 0), K_2 - K_1)$ Moderately bullish
Bear put $p(K_2) - p(K_1)$	$\min(\max(K_2 - S_T, 0), K_2 - K_1)$ Moderately bearish

Spreads: max loss = net cost; max gain = strike width − cost; bull BE = low strike + cost; bear BE = high strike − cost.

European box: bull call + bear put. Constant payoff $K_2 - K_1$, value $(K_2 - K_1)e^{-rT}$. American early exercise complicates replication.

Butterfly: $c(K_1) - 2c(K_2) + c(K_3)$, equal spacing. Peak payoff $K_2 - K_1$ at K_2; zero outside wings. Low-movement view.

Q · Butterfly cost/profit/BEs? Calls at strikes 90, 100, 110 cost 14.2, 8.1, 4.3. Buy 1 low + 1 high, sell 2 middle: cost $14.2 - 2(8.1) + 4.3 = 2.3$. Peak payoff 10 at $S_T = 100$ → max profit $10 - 2.3 = 7.7$. BEs $90 + 2.3 = 92.3$, $110 - 2.3 = 107.7$.

Straddle: $c(K) + p(K)$, payoff $|S_T - K|$; BEs $K \pm (c + p)$.

Strangle: $p(K_1) + c(K_2)$; payoff $\max(K_1 - S_T, 0) + \max(S_T - K_2, 0)$; BEs: low strike − cost; high strike + cost. Lower cost, larger move needed.

Strip: call + 2 puts (down bias): $\max(S_T - K, 0) + 2\max(K - S_T, 0)$. **Strap:** 2 calls + put (up bias): $2\max(S_T - K, 0) + \max(K - S_T, 0)$.

Calendar: short near, long far, same strike. Far leg retains time value at near expiry. **Diagonal:** different strikes and expiries.

Principal protection: budget 100 → bond $100e^{-rT}$ + call budget $100(1 - e^{-rT})$, assuming nonnegative budget and risk-free bond.

7 · One-step replication · no yield

$S_u = S_0 u$, $S_d = S_0 d$; f_u, f_d option values; Δ shares per option unit.

$\Delta = (f_u - f_d)/(S_u - S_d)$

$\Pi_u = \Delta S_u - f_u = \Pi_d = \Delta S_d - f_d$

$f = \Delta S_0 - (\Delta S_u - f_u)e^{-r\Delta t}$.

Long Δ shares − one option is riskless. To hedge a short of 1,000 option units, hold 1000Δ shares (negative means short shares).

Q · Price/hedge a 3-month call? $S_0 = 20$, up 22, down 18, $K = 21$, $r = .04$. Payoffs $1, 0 \to$ $\Delta = (1 - 0)/(22 - 18) = .25$. Buy .25 shares, short one call: both states pay $22(.25) - 1 = 18(.25) = 4.5$. Thus $5 - f = 4.5e^{-.01} \to f = .5498$.

8 · Risk-neutral pricing

$p = (a - d)/(u - d)$; require $d < a < u$ so $0 < p < 1$.

$f = e^{-r\Delta t}[pf_u + (1 - p)f_d]$

Underlying	Growth a
No-dividend stock	$e^{r\Delta t}$
Yield stock / index	$e^{(r-q)\Delta t}$
FX (domestic/foreign)	$e^{(r-r_f)\Delta t}$
Futures	1

Discount at **domestic r in all cases**. FX foreign rate acts as yield. Non-income forward $F_0 = S_0 e^{rT}$.

Under Q: $E^Q[S_{next} \mid S] = Sa$. Physical stock probability $p^* = (e^{\mu\Delta t} - d)/(u - d)$. p prices; p^* forecasts. Non-dividend: $dS/S = \mu dt + \sigma dW$ becomes $rdt + \sigma dW^Q$ under Q; same volatility.

9 · CRR and multi-step tree

N steps; i time index; j up moves.

$\Delta t = T/N$, $u = e^{\sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}}$, $d = 1/u$

$S_{ij} = S_0 u^j d^{i-j}$.

CRR matches local diffusion variance as step shrinks. Exact relative variance $p(1-p)(u-d)^2 = a(u+d) - ud - a^2$. Convergence need not be monotonic.

Two-step European:

$f_0 = e^{-2r\Delta t}[p^2 f_{uu}$

$+2p(1-p)f_{ud} + (1-p)^2 f_{dd}]$.

Terminal values: calls $\max(S_{N,j} - K, 0)$; puts $\max(K - S_{N,j}, 0)$.

European: discounted continuation.

American: $f = \max(\text{continuation}, \text{exercise})$ at every earlier node, including root. Recompute delta as stock/time changes.

10 · Worked binomial pricing

Q · Price two-step European call? $S_0 = 20, K = 21, u = 1.1, d = .9, r = .04, \Delta t = .25$. Terminal stocks 24.2, 19.8, 16.2 → call payoffs 3.2, 0, 0; only two up moves pay. $p = (e^{.01} - .9)/.2 = .550251$. Price $e^{-.02}p^2(3.2) = .9497$; L7 p.13's .9334 is inconsistent.

Q · Price put; when exercise early? $S_0 = 50, K = 52, u = 1.2, d = .8, r = .05, \Delta t = 1, N = 2$. Terminal payoffs 0, 4, 20; $p = .628178$. At $S = 40$: waiting 9.4636 vs exercise $52 - 40 = 12$ → exercise. At 60: continue at 1.4147. Root $e^{-.05}[p(1.4147) + (1-p)12] = 5.0894$; European uses 9.4636 instead of 12 → 4.1923.

11 · Stochastic notation & rules

L8: $z(t)$ level, Δz increment, ϵ shock. L9 p.38: u, v normal draws. Exercises: W_t, X_t, U, V; supplement: $Z(t)$. $N(m, v)$ = mean m, **variance** v. Φ = standard normal CDF.

$a(x,t)$: drift; $b(x,t)$: diffusion; b^2 = variance rate. This a differs from binomial growth. F_t: information at t; E_t, Var_t: conditional moments.

Drift units: value/time; diffusion: value/$\sqrt{time}$; variance rate: value²/time. Use years consistently (month 1/12, quarter 1/4).

$E[\sum Y_i] = \sum E[Y_i]$ always.

$Var(\sum Y_i) = \sum Var(Y_i)$

$+2\sum_{i<j} Cov(Y_i, Y_j)$.

$Var(aX + bY) = a^2\,Var\,X$

$+b^2\,Var\,Y + 2ab\,Cov(X, Y)$.

Independent ⇒ uncorrelated (finite moments). Converse only with extra conditions, e.g. joint Gaussianity.

12 · Standard Wiener / Brownian

$z(0) = 0$; continuous paths; independent increments on disjoint intervals; $z(t) - z(s) \sim N(0, t-s)$.

$E[z(T)] = 0$, $Var(z(T)) = T$

$SD(z(T)) = \sqrt{T}$

$\Delta z = \sqrt{\Delta t}\epsilon$, fresh $\epsilon \sim N(0,1)$ each step.

Variances add; SDs do not. Quarter time → quarter variance, half SD. Continuous path ≠ differentiable path.

Markov: conditional future given present does not need earlier history. Does not imply independent levels. Time/state may be discrete or continuous.

Q · Standard $W_0 = 0$: scale, law, tail? For $\Delta t = .01$, $\Delta W = \sqrt{.01}\varepsilon = .1\varepsilon$. Interval $[2, 5]$ has length 3, so $W_5 - W_2 \sim N(0, 3)$. Since $W_1 \sim N(0,1)$, $P(W_1 > 1.5) = 1 - \Phi(1.5) = .0668$.

13 · Generalized Wiener: exact

Constant a, b: $dx = a\,dt + b\,dz$

$x(T) = x(0) + aT + b[z(T) - z(0)]$

$x(T) \sim N(x(0) + aT, b^2T)$

$\Delta x \sim N(a\Delta t, b^2\Delta t)$

$SD(x(T)) = |b|\sqrt{T}$.

Exact finite-step update:

$x(t + \Delta t) = x(t) + a\Delta t + b\sqrt{\Delta t}\epsilon$.

For $T > 0, b \neq 0$:

$P(x(T) < L) = \Phi\left(\frac{L - x(0) - aT}{|b|\sqrt{T}}\right)$.

Q12 · Cash reserve: law, moments, tail? $dX = 8dt + 12dW$, $X_0 = 30$; millions, years. Drift 8, variance rate $12^2 = 144$. At 1 year: mean $30 + 8 = 38$, variance $144 \to X_1 \sim N(38, 144)$. Half-year mean $30 + 8(.5) = 34$; 2-year SD $12\sqrt{2}$. Below 25 after 1 year: standardize $(25 - 38)/12 = -13/12 \to$ probability .1393.

14 · Itô process: local moments

$dx = a(x,t)dt + b(x,t)dz$

$E_t[\Delta x] \approx a(x_t, t)\Delta t$

$Var_t(\Delta x) \approx b^2(x_t, t)\Delta t$

$SD_t(\Delta x) \approx |b(x_t, t)|\sqrt{\Delta t}$.

Freeze coefficients at current state. Exact for constant coefficients; generally approximate otherwise.

Euler: $x_{t+\Delta t} \approx x_t + a(x_t, t)\Delta t$

$+b(x_t, t)\sqrt{\Delta t}\varepsilon$.

Q14 · Monthly change and Euler next value? $dX = (4 + .2X)dt + .15X\,dW$, current $X = 80$, $\Delta t = 1/12$. Substitute state first: $a = 4 + .2(80) = 20$, $b = .15(80) = 12$. Mean change $\approx 20/12 = 1.6667$; variance $\approx 12^2/12 = 12$. Next value $\approx 80 + 20/12 + \sqrt{12}\varepsilon$. The mean is a **change**, not the next level.

Choose the method

Constant $a, b \to$ exact (§13). Variable $a, b \to$ local/Euler (§14,17). Option price → Q (§8–10). Real-world paths → μ (§16–17).

15 · Mean reversion

$dx_t = \kappa(\theta - x_t)dt + \eta dz_t$

$\kappa > 0$: speed; θ: target; η: diffusion. Drift positive below target, negative above. Variance rate η^2.

Q13 · Mean reversion: drift and local change? $\kappa = .6, \theta = 50, \eta = 8$. Drift $.6(50 - X)$ at $X = 40, 50, 65$ gives $6, 0, -9$: toward 50, not a guaranteed path. At 40, $\Delta t = .1$: mean change $\approx 6(.1) = .6$; variance $\approx 8^2(.1) = 6.4$.

16 · GBM: dollars vs percentages

$dS_t = \mu S_t dt + \sigma S_t dz_t$

$dS_t/S_t = \mu dt + \sigma dz_t$.

Local change	Mean	SD
Proportional	$\mu\Delta t$	$\sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}$
Dollars	$\mu S\Delta t$	$\sigma S\sqrt{\Delta t}$

Dollar variance $\sigma^2 S^2 \Delta t$. Drift coefficient μS; diffusion σS; variance rate $(\sigma S)^2$. μ is annual expected proportional drift, σ annualized volatility.

Local normal approximation ≠ exact long-horizon GBM return distribution. If $\sigma = 0$: exact deterministic $S_t = S_0 e^{\mu t}$.

Q15 · Monthly return vs dollar change? $S = 120, \mu = .09, \sigma = .24$. Mean return $\approx .09/12 = .0075$ (0.75%); SD $\approx .24/\sqrt{12} = .069282$ (6.9282%). Multiply each by 120: dollar mean 9, SD 8.3138; SD is not variance.

17 · Euler simulation

$S_{t_{k+1}} = S_{t_k}(1 + \mu\Delta t + \sigma\sqrt{\Delta t}\varepsilon_k)$

Use updated S_i, not always S_0. Independent shocks ≠ independent prices. Euler can give negative prices; smaller steps reduce discretization error, not randomness.

Q16 · Simulate 3 months? $S_0 = 100, \mu = .06, \sigma = .2$; shocks $.5, -1.2, .8$. First: $S_1 = 100[1 + .06/12 + .2(.5)/\sqrt{12}] = 103.3868$. Reuse S_1 with shock $-1.2 \to S_2 = 96.7408$; reuse S_2 with $.8 \to S_3 = 101.6928$. Keep full precision; this is one path, not a forecast.

18 · Correlated increments

ρ = correlation, $-1 \le \rho \le 1$.

$\mathrm{Cov}(\Delta z_1, \Delta z_2) = \rho\Delta t$

$\mathrm{Cov}_t(\Delta x_1, \Delta x_2) \approx \rho b_1 b_2 \Delta t$

$\mathrm{Cov}_t(\Delta S_1, \Delta S_2) \approx \rho\sigma_1\sigma_2 S_1 S_2 \Delta t$.

Constant coefficients: exact increment covariance. Local correlation = ρ for positive coefficients; exact for constant coefficients. Finite-horizon state-dependent changes need not have correlation ρ.

Q18 · Quarter-year joint changes? $dX_1 = 3dt + 5dW_1$, $dX_2 = 2dt + 7dW_2$, $\rho = .65$. Means $3(.25) = .75$, $2(.25) = .5$; variances $5^2(.25) = 6.25$, $7^2(.25) = 12.25$. Covariance $.65(5)(7)(.25) = 5.6875$; divide by both SDs → correlation .65. Constant coefficients make these exact.

19 · Generate correlated normals

Independent $u, v \sim N(0,1)$:

$\varepsilon_1 = u, \quad \varepsilon_2 = \rho u + \sqrt{1-\rho^2}v$.

$E[\varepsilon_i] = 0$; $\mathrm{Var}(\varepsilon_2) = \rho^2 + (1-\rho^2) = 1$;

$\mathrm{Cov}(\varepsilon_1, \varepsilon_2) = \rho$.

Same u within pair; fresh pair across time. $\rho = 0$: independent; $\rho = \pm 1$: perfect dependence.

20 · Brownian covariance identities

$\mathrm{Cov}(Z(s), Z(t)) = \min(s,t)$

$\mathrm{Corr}(Z(s), Z(t)) = \min(s,t)/\sqrt{st}$ for $s, t > 0$.

Forward intervals $a \le b, c \le d$:

$\mathrm{Cov}(Z(b) - Z(a), Z(d) - Z(c))$

$= \max(0, \min(b,d) - \max(a,c))$

= overlap length.

General linear combinations:

$\mathrm{Cov}(\sum_i a_i Z(t_i), \sum_j b_j Z(s_j))$

$= \sum_{ij} a_i b_j \min(t_i, s_j)$.

Linear Brownian combinations are jointly Gaussian: covariance 0 $\iff$ independence. For nonlinear functions, use actual independence properties; zero covariance alone is insufficient.

21 · All nine dependence cases

Q: Supplement: $Z(0) = 0$. Is each pair independent? Find covariance and decide independence. Zero cov + joint normal ⇒ independent; nonzero cov ⇒ dependent.

Pair	Cov / result
$Z(2)$, $Z(4) - Z(2)$	0 · disjoint increments
$Z(2)$, $Z(4)$	2 · later level contains earlier
$Z(3) - Z(1)$, $Z(5) - Z(3)$	0 · disjoint increments
$Z(3) - Z(1)$, $Z(4) - Z(2)$	1 · overlap $[2,3]$
$Z(5) - Z(2)$, $Z(2) - Z(1)$	0 · disjoint increments
$Z(4) + Z(2)$, $Z(4) - Z(2)$	$4 - 2 = 2$ · dependent
$2Z(3) - 2Z(2) + Z(1)$, $Z(3) - Z(1)$	$1 - 1 = 0$ · joint normal
$Z(2)^2$, $Z(4) - Z(2)$	Independent*
$Z(4) - 2Z(2)$, $Z(2)$	$2 - 4 = -2$ · dependent

Case g: let $X = Z(2) - Z(1)$, $Y = Z(3) - Z(2)$, iid $N(0,1)$. Pair $Y - X, Y + X$ has covariance $1 - 1 = 0$, jointly normal.

*Case h: squaring a variable independent of the future increment preserves independence; the square is not Gaussian.

22 · Exam calculation patterns

Bounds: compute PV strike first. **Parity:** same K, T, check dividends and style. **Profit:** subtract premiums only after combining payoffs.

Tree: time units → u, d, a, p → check p → stock nodes → terminal payoff → backward discount → American exercise comparison → delta.

SDE: identify a, b → substitute current state → variance rate b^2 → multiply by Δt → SD square root. Mark exact/local.

Q17 · Quarter vs month: dollar moments? GBM $S = 90, \mu = .07, \sigma = .25$. Use mean $\approx (.07)(90)\Delta t$, variance $\approx (.25 \cdot 90)^2 \Delta t$. At $\Delta t = .25$: $1.575, 126.5625$; at $1/12$: $.525, 42.1875$. These are changes conditional on current price.

Q20 · Monthly joint dollar moments? $S_1 = 100, S_2 = 80$, $\mu_1 = .08, \mu_2 = .05$, $\sigma_1 = .2, \sigma_2 = .3$, $\rho = .5$. Apply $\mu_i S_i/12$ → means $.6667, .3333$; $\sigma_i S_i/\sqrt{12}$ → SDs $5.7735, 6.9282$. Covariance $\approx .5(.2)(.3)(100)(80)/12 = 20$ (dollars²), not correlation .5.

23 · Common traps / scope

Variance is SD squared. Brownian level is not increment. ΔW scales with $\sqrt{\Delta t}$, drift with Δt. Uncorrelated need not mean independent. Risk-neutral probability is not physical probability. American value uses max, not just expectation.

Sources: supplied L1–9, Brownian supplement and Suggested Exercises 1. Full website: all 20 questions / 97 subparts + lecture exercises. This two-page sheet is a selected reference, not every worked solution.

L2's referenced margin spreadsheet was not supplied. L7 p.13 root value corrected against L6. No unprovided advanced pricing chapters included.